

SKILLS GUIDE



Excellent verbal and written skills help to express ideas clearly to varied readerships or audiences.



The ability to work with people in many teams, including editors, designers, and producers.



Perseverance and a "can-do" attitude, helping to create and present a story for the target audience.



The flexibility to take on stories that arise without warning and to follow them as events unfold.



Good organizational skills to meet tight deadlines, especially when juggling multiple stories.



NEWSPAPER JOURNALIST

Provides information to the public about events, people, and ideas. The role involves detailed research, writing, and fact-checking.



MAGAZINE JOURNALIST

Researches and writes news articles and features for a variety of periodicals, including popular titles, business journals, and trade publications.



ONLINE JOURNALIST

Produces content for online publication on one or many different topics. This requires good journalistic and computer skills. The ability to work in a variety of media—including video and sound—is extremely beneficial.

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Writing • Research • Meeting and interacting with people • Media • Social media • Computers • Current affairs



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS A degree followed by graduate training in journalism is desirable; internships are also available for on-the-job training.



LIFESTYLE Work is project-based, with long and irregular hours, which can extend over weekends and holidays. Some jobs require frequent traveling.



LOCATION You may be based in an office, but will need to travel to conduct research and interviews depending on your chosen field.



THE REALITIES Tight deadlines and long hours are common. Working conditions can be poor or dangerous, for example in war or disaster zones.

RELATED CAREERS

► **WRITER** *see pp. 52–53*

► **EDITOR** *see pp. 56–57*

► **ADVERTISING COPYWRITER** Produces the concise and persuasive written words, or "copy," for advertisements. This can range from slogans and text for printed advertisements and leaflets to radio jingles and scripts for TV commercials.



As global newspaper sales continue to fall, more people are choosing the Internet and radio for their daily news.

